CIA analysts had observed that even after wresting power from the Shah in 1979, Khomeini's lust for vengeance was not satisfied. Their note said:

The Shah's entrance into the US in October 1979, however, brought Khomeini's two hated enemies together. For Khomeini, commander in chief of the armed forces, the Shah's arrival in the US provided an external focus around which to rally the country. This was reflected in his rhetoric, which shifted from portraying the Shah as the prime opponent to the Shah as a puppet of the US.

On the other hand, Khamenei, who had studied under Khomeini, had been involved in activities against the Shah for a long time. Vipul said Khamenei was not only the president of Iran but also influenced society as Tehran's Friday prayers leader. India had very insignificant links with Khamenei's opposition led by Akbar Hashemi Rafsanjani, head of the assembly known as Majlis. He was busy with internal power tussles and several attempts to approach him had been futile. Rafsanjani had said that America continued to be Iran's enemy. In Khameini's view, Iran had no plan whatsoever to cooperate with or get near the United States. In contrast, Pakistan under Zia-ul-Haq had enhanced its ties with the Iranian government and Vipul informed me that by the end of 1984, military assistance from Pakistan to Tehran flowed unhindered. The ISI chief, Lt. General Akhtar Abdur Rahman, was a staunch supporter of close relations with Iran and other Arab states to keep a significant hold over Afghanistan.

Anil Prasad gave the go-ahead for the operation in 1984. Vipul was to work as a lone wolf. In January 1985, he landed in Damascus, capital city of the Syrian Arab Republic. He had an